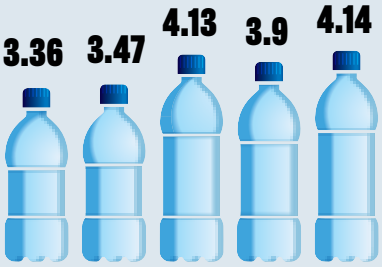
THE INDIA STACK

The increase in plastic waste generated in the country

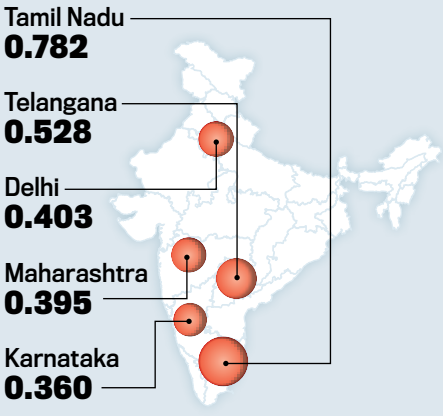
(Million tonnes per annum)



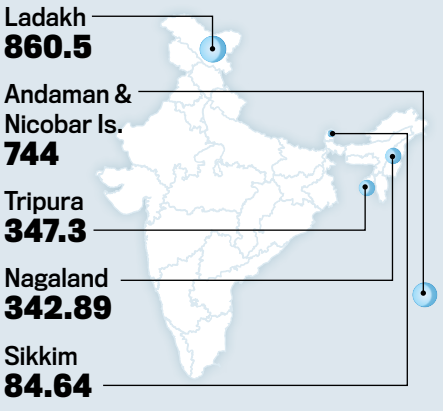
PLASTIC WASTE GENERATORS

Quantity generated by the states/ UTs in FY23

TOP 5 *(Million tonnes per annum)*



BOTTOM 5 *(Tonnes per annum)*



Sources: Central Pollution Control Board data shared by the government in Lok Sabha



HINDUSTAN TIMES

JUNK JUNCTION The Juhu Beach in Mumbai

GROWING SEA OF PLASTIC

Plastic waste has devastating consequences all around—polluting oceans, harming wildlife, endangering health and the climate

ENVIRONMENTAL

- Plastics are non-biodegradable, taking 500-1,000 years to decompose, causing long-term accumulation in ecosystems
- They contribute 80% of marine pollution, with 4.8-12.7 million tonnes entering oceans yearly, forming garbage patches like the Great Pacific Garbage Patch
- Over time, plastics fragment into microplastics, contaminating water, soil and air

WILDLIFE

- Microplastics find their way into the food chain, being consumed by wildlife
- Animals are often entangled in plastic, leading to injuries, suffocation or death

HUMAN HEALTH

- Plastics contain toxic chemicals, including pesticides and flame retardants, linked to: cancer, heart disease, reproductive disorders and other severe health conditions

CLIMATE

- Plastics are derived from fossil fuels, and their production accounts for at least 5.3% of global greenhouse gas emissions, worsening climate change

GLOBAL PLASTIC POLLUTION IS EXPECTED TO TRIPLE BY 2040. PLASTIC WILL OUTWEIGH FISH BY 2050 AND MAY EVEN EXCEED THE BIOMASS OF ALL HUMANS

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY